

TRAI calls for transparency

TRAI asks Indian celloos to update tariff details on their web sites and points of sale

Is it really coming?

BlackBerry Playbook OS 2.0 expected to roll out on 17th February



Nokia N8

cial launch, the Play seamlessly brings together the Android smartphone and the controller of the PS3. While the phone is pretty standard, gaming on it is taken to the next level. With the dedicated controller, the gaming experience comes very close to what you get on the dedicated portable gaming console – the PlayStation Portable. What limits it is the OS itself, which really isn't a gaming platform at all. More than that, the Xperia Play is a definite head turner at social gatherings, and you will not have to pay a lot for it.

Ah, the first of the Windows Phone Mango devices – the HTC Radar. It seems to have

everything mixed in generous quantity, performance, build quality and a price that makes this a very decent mid-range WP7.5 device. The build quality follows a pattern very similar to the ones we've seen along the way on multiple devices, namely the HTC Legend and the HTC Flyer tablet – the unibody design with a plastic portion that can be opened to access the SIM slot and battery slots. The mixture of silver and white does make it look a bit bland, but you wouldn't really care because Windows Phone OS is absolutely brilliant post the Mango update. While the 3.8-inch S-LCD display doesn't really match up to the likes of the Super AMOLED on the much less expensive Samsung Omnia W, it isn't a disappointment by any stretch of imagination. There is 8GB internal storage, with no slot for memory expansion. If you want a Windows Phone in this price budget, the HTC Radar should definitely be on the shortlist.

If you've forgotten about it, we would like to re-introduce the BlackBerry Bold 9780, fondly known as the Bold 3 when it was launched last year. This is the only non-touchscreen device on our comparison test this time around. However, for around ₹22,000, the Bold 9780 does offer a very solid product that has stood the test of time. Yes, it isn't the most powerful package in the modern day stakes, but you essentially get a Bold series smartphone, and not have to pay a lot for it. RIM hasn't said anything about

whether this phone will get the OS 7 update, but even with the OS 6, it's definitely worth a consideration. Will appeal to students or the young professionals, who need BBM and mails on the move.

Bewildering as it is, the Bold 9790 (incidentally not the Bold 4 or anything like that) makes



HTC Radar

us wonder as to whether the lines between the Bold and Curve series of smartphones are actually blurring? We say this because the Bold 9790 doesn't feel like a higher end Bold smartphone at all. The plasticity feel is all too dominant, and does become even more so when you look at the price tag. Performance is impressive, thanks to the combination of a 1 GHz processor and the less resource hungry OS 7. However, the phone doesn't feel as high quality to hold, as you would have hoped for after paying lots of moolah.

What we have up next is the first dual core smartphone to arrive in the Indian market, the LG Optimus 2X. Incidentally, this is the most inexpensive dual

core phone around as well. The build quality is quite okay, but the most impressive is the bright display. If you aren't careful about turning it down, your eyes will feel the strain. The dual core processor isn't a beast in terms of the experience on offer. You won't even notice the performance boost, but will appreciate the extra grunt when opening applications and playing games. Sadly though, the Optimus 2X is still stuck on Android 2.2, but LG says the ICS update will arrive in the second quarter of 2012. Might not be a bad deal.

The BlackBerry Torch 9860 is very different from the traditional BlackBerry look. With a 3.7-inch display, the Torch is essentially aimed at the user who is enticed by the touchscreen experience of an Android, but wouldn't want to give up the BlackBerry ecosystem. Having said that, the real niggle with OS 7 is that it's designed to work on touchscreen-only phones as well as phones that have a QWERTY keypad. And that means that the experience on a touchscreen phone isn't as fluid as that on an Android or the iOS.

Nokia's Lumia 800 is one brilliant phone. The UI is slick,



Sony Ericsson Xperia Play



BlackBerry Bold 9790